

The Tantra of the Blazing Flame of the Ḍākinī

Ḍākinījvalāmukhatantra · Toh 842 · Derge Kangyur

མཁའ་འགྲོ་མ་ལེ་འབར་བའ་རིན་པོ་ལྷ་

This short work, the twenty-second chapter of the Tantra of the Blazing Flame of the Ḍākinī (Tibetan: Mkha' 'gro ma me lce 'bar ba'i rgyud; Sanskrit title not determinable from the lines given here), is titled in English the "Chapter of the Complete Prophecy." It is a prophetic and protective teaching, spoken in the voice of the dark goddess's tradition, which enjoins offerings to the Victors of the five families and the keeping of the twenty-eight pledges. It also lists the grave circumstances under which the goddess draws her weapon, such as the destruction of the treasury, contempt for the Three Jewels, the decline of the Buddha's teaching, or the flourishing of the enemies of the Three Jewels. It is Toh 842 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the Tantra section.

I give this prophecy.

Here ends the twenty-second chapter, the chapter of the complete prophecy, from the Tantra of the Blazing Flame of the Ḍākinī.

When you make offerings, always make offerings to the Victors of the five families. When you keep guard, guard the twenty-eight pledges. When an enemy appears, the dark goddess draws her weapon. For a small fault, for a mere quarrel, the weapon is not drawn. If my treasury is destroyed, the weapon is drawn. If the Three Jewels are held in contempt, the weapon is drawn. If the Buddha's teaching is being destroyed, the weapon is drawn. If enemies of the Three Jewels flourish, the weapon is drawn.

Translator's Notes

- The passage breaks off mid-sentence at its end, so the final line is rendered as it stands. The speaker of the verses is not identified within this excerpt. "The dark goddess" renders མཁའ་འགྲོ་མ་ལེ་འབར་བའ་རིན་པོ་ལྷ་, and the verses read as a protector's warning about when she acts. The twenty-eight pledges are the standard samaya count in this tantric context, but the excerpt does not list them. "My treasury" translates རྒྱུ་ལྗོན་པོ་ལྷ་, a storehouse of offerings or holdings. The wording of the first line, "give this prophecy," follows the Tibetan མཁའ་འགྲོ་མ་ལེ་འབར་བའ་རིན་པོ་ལྷ་, which is the same word used in the chapter title.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.